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Method and electrical device for training cross-domain classifier

Abstract

A method for training a cross-domain classifier includes the following steps: (a) obtaining training samples from a first database and test samples from a second database; (b) performing an inference procedure to the test samples by the classifier to generate corresponding predicted labels; (c) for a certain category, obtaining the training samples and the test samples belonging to this category, and training an generative adversarial network (GAN) according to the obtained training samples and test samples; (d) performing a style conversion to the obtained training samples by the GAN to obtain synthetic samples; (e) merging the synthetic samples with the training samples to train the classifier; and repeating the above steps (b) to (e). The classifier will be suitable for cross-domain databases based on this iterative procedure.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims priority to Taiwan Application Serial Number 112106835 filed Feb. 24, 2023, which is herein incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

Field of Invention

(2) This disclosure is related to a method and an electrical device for training a classifier capable of handling samples from multiple databases (i.e. cross-domain).

Description of Related Art

(3) Machine learning algorithms can be used to train a classifier, for example, to categorize an image into two categories: containing people and not containing people. Training a classifier requires a large number of training samples, but typically these samples come from the same database. Training samples from the same database share several common attributes, such as being captured by the same device, having similar color tones, and similar backgrounds. However, in various applications or competitions, test samples and training samples may belong to different databases. In other words, test samples may have vastly different attributes from training samples, which usually results in a decrease in classification accuracy. How to address this issue is a concern for technical personnel in this field.

SUMMARY

(4) Embodiments of the disclosure provide a method performed by an electrical device. The method includes the following steps: (a) obtaining multiple training samples from a first database, and obtaining multiple test samples from a second database, in which each of the training samples has a ground-truth label belonging to one of multiple categories; (b) performing, by a classifier, an inference procedure on the test samples to obtain multiple predicted labels, in which each of the predicted labels belongs to one of the categories; (c) for a first category, obtaining the training samples having the ground-truth labels belonging to the first category and obtaining the test samples having the predicted labels belonging to the first category, and training a generative adversarial network according to the obtained training samples and the obtained test samples; (d) performing, by the generative adversarial network, a style conversion on the obtained training samples to obtain multiple synthetic samples; (e) merging the synthetic samples with the training samples to train the classifier; and repeating the step (b) to the step (e).

(5) In some embodiments, each of the predicted labels has a confidence level. The step (c) includes: obtaining the test samples corresponding to the predicted labels belonging to the first category and having the confidence levels greater than a threshold; and increasing the threshold as training epochs progress.

(6) In some embodiments, before the step (b), the method further includes: pre-training the classifier according to the training samples; and pre-training the generative adversarial network according to the training samples and the test samples.

(7) In some embodiments, the training samples and the test samples are eye images, and the categories include a true-category and a false-category.

(8) In some embodiments, the step (c) includes: training another generative adversarial network for another one of the categories.

(9) From another aspect, embodiments of the present disclosure provide an electrical device including a memory storing multiple instructions and a processor communicatively connected to the memory. The processor is configured to execute the instructions to perform the method.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The invention can be more fully understood by reading the following detailed description of the embodiment, with reference made to the accompanying drawings as follows.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an electrical device according to an embodiment.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of the samples processed in some embodiments.
- (4) FIG. 3 is a flowchart of a cross-domain training method according to an embodiment.
- (5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of sample allocation during training according to an embodiment.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of the warm-up mechanism according to an embodiment.
- (7) FIG. 6 is a diagram of samples of style conversion according to an embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Specific embodiments of the present invention are further described in detail below with reference to the accompanying drawings, however, the embodiments described are not intended to limit the present invention and it is not intended for the description of operation to limit the order of implementation. Moreover, any device with equivalent functions that is produced from a structure formed by a recombination of elements shall fall within the scope of the present invention. Additionally, the drawings are only illustrative and are not drawn to actual size.

(9) The using of “first”, “second”, “third”, etc. in the specification should be understood for identifying units or data described by the same terminology, but are not referred to particular order or sequence.

(10) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an electrical device according to an embodiment. Referring to FIG. 1, an electric device **100** may be a smart phone, a tablet, a personal computer, a notebook computer, a server, a distributed computer, a cloud server, an industrial computer, or any electric device having computing ability, which is not limited in the disclosure. The electrical device **100** includes a processor **110** and a memory **120**. The processor **110** is communicatively connected to the memory **120** through any wired or wireless communication means, or through the Internet. The processor **110** can be a central processor, microprocessor, microcontroller, image processing chip, special application integrated circuit, etc. The memory **120** can be a random access memory, read-only memory, flash memory, floppy disk, hard disk, optical disk, USB drive, tape, or a database that can be accessed through the Internet. The memory **120** stores multiple instructions which are executed by the processor **110** to perform a method for training a cross-domain classifier.

(11) In general, one classifier and multiple generative adversarial networks (GANs) are trained in the disclosure. The GANs are used to perform style conversion on training samples to increase the amount of training data, while the classifier is used to provide labels for test samples. The classified test samples are then used to train the GANs. This means that the classifier and GANs are iteratively trained. The following will provide a detailed explanation of this method.

(12) FIG. 2 is a schematic diagram of the samples processed in some embodiments. Referring to FIG. 2, in some embodiments, the processed samples are images that include a human eye and can be used for iris recognition. The iris is unique, stable, non-invasive, and suitable for biometric identification technology. As iris recognition systems become increasingly popular and do not require manual supervision, the security of resisting attacks becomes crucial. The most common security vulnerability is a presentation attack. The definition of the presentation attack is “a presentation of biometric data captured by a subsystem aimed at interfering with the operation of a biometric system.” In other words, the attacker presents an attack sample to the iris sensor to manipulate the system to make incorrect decisions. The attacker may have obtained personal iris images that can access the system and hope to grant access by presenting the attack sample. For example, an image **201** is a real and authorized human eye image, while an image **202** is an attack sample generated by printing on paper or displaying on a screen. An image **203** is a real and authorized image, while an image **204** is generated using textured contact lenses. An image **205** is a real and authorized image, while an image **206** is a synthesized image generated by artificial

intelligence technology. An image **207** is a real and authorized image, while an image **208** is an image of a dead person. Within a few hours after death, the texture of the iris remains intact and can deceive the system.

(13) The classifier trained here is used to recognize whether an image is real or fake (i.e., an attack sample). However, the techniques disclosed below can also be applied to other categories, such as identifying objects in images as humans, cats, dogs, cars, etc. Additionally, the techniques disclosed below can be applied to various types of data, such as sound signals, text, electrocardiograms, medical images, and so on.

(14) FIG. **3** is a flowchart of a cross-domain training method according to an embodiment. FIG. **4** is a schematic diagram of sample allocation during training according to an embodiment. Referring to FIGS. **3** and **4**, in step **301**, training samples are obtained from a first database, and test samples are obtained from a second database. These training and test samples can be, for example, eye images. The first and second databases can be provided by different institutions, captured by different devices, obtained at different locations, or one of the databases may be publicly available before a competition while the other is the database to be tested during the competition that is not limited in the disclosure. Each training sample has a ground-truth label that belongs to one of multiple categories. In this embodiment, a first category is referred to as “True” and a second category is referred to as “False.” In FIG. **3**, the training samples mentioned above are divided into the training samples **421** of the first category and the training samples **422** of the second category. The test samples **410** do not have ground-truth labels.

(15) Next, in step **302**, an inference procedure is performed on the test samples **410** by using the classifier **430** to generate multiple predicted labels. The classifier **430** can be any machine learning algorithm, such as convolutional neural network, support vector machine, random forest, and so on that is not limited in the disclosure. In some embodiments, the architecture of the convolutional neural network is derived from LeNet, AlexNet, VGG, GoogLeNet, ResNet, DenseNet, EfficientNet, or YOLO (You Only Look Once), etc. In this embodiment, each predicted label belongs to the first category or second category, and depending on the predicted category, the test samples **410** are divided into test samples **411** of the first category and test samples **412** of the second category.

(16) Each category has a branch. For example, the first category corresponds to steps **303** and **304**, while the second category corresponds to steps **305** and **306**. The first category is explained first. In the step **303**, the training samples **421** corresponding to the ground-truth labels of the first category and the test samples **411** corresponding to the predicted labels of the first category are obtained. A generative adversarial network **441** is trained based on the training samples **421** and the test samples **411**. In this embodiment, the generative adversarial network **441** is based on the network architecture proposed in the paper “Contrastive learning for unpaired image-to-image translation” by Park, Taesung, et al., presented at the European Conference on Computer Vision in 2020. In other implementations, the generative adversarial network **441** can be a cycle-consistent adversarial network (cycleGAN) or any suitable generative adversarial network. The generative adversarial network is used to transform one probability distribution into another, and it has already been widely applied, for example, to change the orientation, expression, features, and skin color of a face. In this approach, the training samples are taken as the source domain for the generative adversarial network, while the test samples are taken as the target domain. This generative adversarial network is used to transform the style of the samples from one database to another database, referred to as style conversion.

(17) In step **304**, multiple synthetic samples **451** are obtained by performing the style conversion on the acquired training samples **421** using the generative adversarial network **441**. In other words, the synthetic samples **451** have the content of the training samples but with the style of the test samples, and their labels are the same as the ground-truth labels of the corresponding training samples **421**. Referring to FIG. **6** for an example of style conversion. An image **610** belongs to the

true-category of the first database and is converted to an image **611** in the style of the second database.

(18) Similar processing is carried out in steps **305** and **306**. In step **305**, training samples **422** and test samples **412** corresponding to the ground-truth labels and the predicted labels of the second category, respectively, are obtained and used to train a generative adversarial network **442**. The generative adversarial network **442** can have the same architecture as the generative adversarial network **441**, but is trained by different data. In other words, different generative adversarial networks **441** and **442** are trained for different categories. In step **306**, the style conversion is performed on the training samples **422** using the generative adversarial network **442** to generate multiple synthetic samples **452**. The labels of the synthetic samples **452** are the same as the corresponding training samples **422**. An example of style conversion can be found in FIG. **6**, where an image **620** belongs to the false-category of the first database, and after being converted to the style of the second database, an image **621** is obtained.

(19) In step **307**, the synthetic samples are merged with the training samples to train the classifier. Specifically, the synthetic samples **451** and the training samples **421** both have the label of “true”, so they are merged together as positive samples **461**. In addition, the synthetic samples **452** and the training samples **422** both have the label of “false”, so they are merged together as negative samples **462**. The classifier **430** is trained based on the positive samples **461** and the negative samples **462**.

(20) The training process is performed iteratively by repeating the steps **302-307** until convergence is achieved. In summary, the test samples **410** are fed into the classifier **430** for classification, and a temporary predicted label is assigned based on the classification result. Then, the generative adversarial networks are trained based on the same category of training samples and test samples. The training samples are then converted into the style of the test samples to increase the amount of data in the training set. As the classification ability of the classifier **430** becomes more accurate, the generative adversarial networks are able to increase the size of the training set more effectively. This leads to a more accurate classifier **430**, which can successfully determine the category of the test samples.

(21) The architecture in FIG. **4** may encounter some issues in the initial stages of training. Firstly, the classification accuracy of the classifier **430** may be poor, and misclassified test samples will be input into the generative adversarial network, causing the two inputs of the generative adversarial network belong to different categories which indicates a mismatch between the resource and target domains. As a result, the synthetic samples produced by the style conversion may not effectively assist in the training classifier **430**. The second issue is that the generative adversarial networks **441** and **442** may not have completed their training, resulting in low-quality generated images that are not helpful for training the classifier **430**. To address these issues, a warm-up mechanism is added before the iteration process (i.e. steps **302-307** in FIG. **3**) in some embodiments.

(22) FIG. **5** is a schematic diagram of the warm-up mechanism according to an embodiment. The warm-up mechanism includes two stages of training epochs **510** and **520**. In the training epochs **510**, the classifier **430** is pre-trained based on the training samples **421** and **422**. Then, in the training epochs **520**, the training samples **421** and **422** are taken as the resource domain, and the test samples **410** are taken as the target domain to pre-train the generative adversarial networks **441** and **442**. The classifier **430** is also trained based on the training samples **421** and **422** in the training epochs **520**. During pre-training, the classification results of the classifier **430** are not input to the generative adversarial networks **441** and **442**, and the output of the generative adversarial networks **441** and **442** are not merged into the training data to train the classifier **430**. That is, the classifier **430** and the generative adversarial networks **441** and **442** are pre-trained separately. In some embodiments, the length of the training epochs **510** is equal to 20 (i.e. 20 epochs), and the length of the training epochs **520** is equal to 20, but this disclosure is not limited to this.

(23) Referring to FIG. **3** and FIG. **4**, when the classifier **430** performs the inference procedure, a

confidence level (or referred to as a probability of belonging to the predicted category) is generated for each predicted label. In the steps **303** and **305**, only the test samples corresponding to the predicted labels with a confidence level greater than a threshold are selected. For example, if the threshold is 0.6, a test sample that is classified as the first category but has a confidence level below 0.6 would not be selected as an input to the generative adversarial network **441**. This threshold setting is to ensure the quality of the generated images and to reduce the number of misclassified test samples input into the generative adversarial networks **441** and **442**. In some embodiments, the threshold is increased as the training epochs progress. For example, the threshold can be set to 0.7 for the first 20 training epochs and then to 0.8 for the next 20 training epochs, and so on. As the training progresses, the accuracy of the classifier **430** will gradually improve, and the confidence level will also increase. Therefore, increasing the threshold gradually can help obtain more accurately classified test samples.

(24) Another aspect of the present disclosure provides a non-transitory computer readable storage medium storing instructions which are executed by the electrical device **100** to perform the method of FIG. **3**. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium may be a random access memory, read-only memory, flash memory, floppy disk, hard disk, optical disk, USB drive, tape, or a database that can be accessed through the Internet.

(25) The main feature of the above method is the use of an iterative approach to train the classifier and the generative adversarial networks. The generative adversarial networks are used for style conversion to increase the amount of data in the training set, while the classifier provides temporary labels for test samples to train the generative adversarial networks, and both their performance is improved together. In addition, because of the style conversion, the classifier can better adapt to the style of the test dataset. In some cross-domain experiments, the average classification error rate of the above embodiments was reduced by about 9.17% compared to known methods.

(26) Although the present invention has been described in considerable detail with reference to certain embodiments thereof, other embodiments are possible. Therefore, the spirit and scope of the appended claims should not be limited to the description of the embodiments contained herein. It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that various modifications and variations can be made to the structure of the present invention without departing from the scope or spirit of the invention. In view of the foregoing, it is intended that the present invention cover modifications and variations of this invention provided they fall within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. A method performed by an electrical device, the method comprising a plurality of steps: (a) obtaining a plurality of training samples from a first database, and obtaining a plurality of test samples from a second database, wherein each of the training samples has a ground-truth label belonging to one of a plurality of categories; (b) performing, by a classifier, an inference procedure on the test samples to obtain a plurality of predicted labels, wherein each of the predicted labels belongs to one of the categories; (c) for a first category of the categories, obtaining the training samples having the ground-truth labels belonging to the first category and obtaining the test samples having the predicted labels belonging to the first category, and training a generative adversarial network according to the obtained training samples and the obtained test samples; (d) performing, by the generative adversarial network, a style conversion on the obtained training samples to obtain a plurality of synthetic samples; (e) merging the synthetic samples with the training samples to train the classifier; and repeating the step (b) to the step (e).

2. The method of claim 1, wherein each of the predicted labels has a confidence level, and the step (c) comprises: obtaining the test samples corresponding to the predicted labels belonging to the first category and having the confidence levels greater than a threshold; and increasing the

threshold as training epochs progress.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein before the step (b), the method further comprises: pre-training the classifier according to the training samples; and pre-training the generative adversarial network according to the training samples and the test samples.

4. The method of claim 1, wherein the training samples and the test samples are eye images, and the categories comprise a true-category and a false-category.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the step (c) comprises: training another generative adversarial network for another one of the categories.

6. An electrical device, comprising: a memory storing a plurality of instructions; and a processor communicatively connected to the memory and configured to execute the instructions to perform a plurality of steps: (a) obtaining a plurality of training samples from a first database, and obtaining a plurality of test samples from a second database, wherein each of the training samples has a ground-truth label belonging to one of a plurality of categories; (b) performing, by a classifier, an inference procedure on the test samples to obtain a plurality of predicted labels, wherein each of the predicted labels belongs to one of the categories; (c) for a first category of the categories, obtaining the training samples having the ground-truth labels belonging to the first category and obtaining the test samples having the predicted labels belonging to the first category, and training a generative adversarial network according to the obtained training samples and the obtained test samples; (d) performing, by the generative adversarial network, a style conversion on the obtained training samples to obtain a plurality of synthetic samples; (e) merging the synthetic samples with the training samples to train the classifier; and repeating the step (b) to the step (e).

7. The electrical device of claim 6, wherein each of the predicted labels has a confidence level, and the step (c) comprises: obtaining the test samples corresponding to the predicted labels belonging to the first category and having the confidence levels greater than a threshold; and increasing the threshold as training epochs progress.

8. The electrical device of claim 6, wherein before the step (b), the steps further comprise: pre-training the classifier according to the training samples; and pre-training the generative adversarial network according to the training samples and the test samples.

9. The electrical device of claim 6, wherein the training samples and the test samples are eye images, and the categories comprise a true-category and a false-category.

10. The electrical device of claim 6, wherein the step (c) comprises: training another generative adversarial network for another one of the categories.

11. A non-transitory computer readable storage medium storing a plurality of instructions which are configured to be executed by an electrical device to perform a plurality of steps: (a) obtaining a plurality of training samples from a first database, and obtaining a plurality of test samples from a second database, wherein each of the training samples has a ground-truth label belonging to one of a plurality of categories; (b) performing, by a classifier, an inference procedure on the test samples to obtain a plurality of predicted labels, wherein each of the predicted labels belongs to one of the categories; (c) for a first category of the categories, obtaining the training samples having the ground-truth labels belonging to the first category and obtaining the test samples having the predicted labels belonging to the first category, and training a generative adversarial network according to the obtained training samples and the obtained test samples; (d) performing, by the generative adversarial network, a style conversion on the obtained training samples to obtain a plurality of synthetic samples; (e) merging the synthetic samples with the training samples to train the classifier; and repeating the step (b) to the step (e).

12. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein each of the predicted labels has a confidence level, and the step (c) comprises: obtaining the test samples corresponding to the predicted labels belonging to the first category and having the confidence levels greater than a threshold; and increasing the threshold as training epochs progress.

13. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein before the step (b),

the method further comprises: pre-training the classifier according to the training samples; and pre-training the generative adversarial network according to the training samples and the test samples.

14. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the training samples and the test samples are eye images, and the categories comprise a true-category and a false-category.

15. The non-transitory computer readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the step (c) comprises: training another generative adversarial network for another one of the categories.
